



PTAB Meeting Minutes: August 20, 2025

Present: Colleen O'Neill, Stacey Allott, Doug Haney, Ashley Garwood, Ezra Schwartzberg, Mary Thill, Aurora White (Village Trustee), Scott McKim (Public Attendee), Megan Gorss (Public Attendee)

Meeting called to order by Chair at 6:00 p.m.

1. Approve June Meeting Minutes: Motion by Julianne Stemp, Second by Ezra Schwartzberg.

2. New Business:

1. **Site visit and Q&A with Scott McKim at planned Boothe River Park on Saranac River:** Scott answered questions from PTAB about the project and pointed out concept plan features at the site. Fundraising is the main goal in this phase with fundraising events being held and grants which were submitted in July and awaiting word on. Easement work is in progress. Park will bring new types of tourism to Downtown and the Village, encourage and facilitate recreational use for visitors and residents, revitalize and promote our waterfront assets, protect and monitor fish and river habitat, and potentially spur new business ventures, and other community opportunities.
2. **Ward Plumadore Park Status:** Village board declined fire tower grant, Aurora White said the board's decision was driven by process, not by fire tower itself; the idea originated with CEF but wasn't an approved project. Kirk Sullivan and other CEF members are working on a public education initiative. Aurora recommended CEF hold a session with village board to lessen confusion and get village support. A task force could follow.
3. **PTAB Budget Resources:** PTAB has access to \$3,333 (\$10,000 split among three advisory boards for use as needed), but there is no PTAB budget, per se. Budget funds do not carry over year to year unless specifically requested (fiscal year June 1- May 31). PTAB decided to discuss funding needs at a future meeting.
4. **Community Enhancement Fund (CEF) PTAB Membership:** Two PTAB volunteers needed for one year term on CEF. PTAB voted to approve the following 1-year term appointments: Stacy Allott renewed term, Jimmy Cunningham as new member. Motion by Mary Thill, Second by Ezra Schwartzberg.

3. Unfinished Business:

1. Initiative and Park Updates

- **Main Street/Church Street/Pine Street Corridor Assessment for One Way and Sidewalk Improvements:** PTAB and DAB action and funding on hold until Katrina can confirm if village board supports the study. One-way road was attempted years ago and reversed. More info on that history is needed. This year the idea resurfaced out of interest in Rail Trail connections to community core and increased usage by pedestrians and bikes. Colleen to

provide PTAB with community feedback received by Katrina from property owners in that corridor. Aurora will follow up with Katrina re: Board support and PTAB will revisit discussion once we get that update.

2. **Mount Pisgah:** Doug provided an update on conceptual design for mountain bike trails at Mount Pisgah. The village board approved the plan. BETA now seeking funding for construction. Ezra and BETA are considering an Adirondack Smart Growth Grant and plan to ask the village community development office if it would submit the application. Aurora clarified that for some grants the village is just the sponsor, for others it writes them.
 3. **Lake Colby Beach:** PTAB is curious about use of new accessible infrastructure. Julianne will stop at the beach and ask a lifeguard for an estimate of use.
 4. **Garwood Park:** Ashley reported still waiting for word on state accessible playground grant application. Need is \$1.1M, grant application \$1M.
 5. **Rail Trail Community Connectivity Wayfinding Signage:** Doug and Colleen reported NYSDEC gave permission to install temporary signage. They met with DEC and ROOST since our last meeting to draft uniform rail trail signage which Lake Placid and Tupper Lake will also have. The purpose is to direct people off the trail and into the community. In Saranac Lake, signage points include Brandy Brook, Two Pine Street crossings, Bloomingdale Ave., and Route 86. Doug and Colleen made an inventory of attractions critical to include (e.g., beach, community center, shopping) and are seeking PTAB input, and then will bring it to Village Board for approval. ROOST will design and print signs at no cost to village.
 6. **Prescott Park:** A new event promotion sign was installed and is managed by Village Code Enforcement.
 7. **Bike Lanes:** Brief discussion on parking in bike lanes and how to enforce. Not PTAB's jurisdiction.
 8. **Community Bike Rides:** Julianne and Doug reported on a successful season. Five rides total, group size 5 to 10, all ages, including adaptive cyclist.
 9. **Suggestion to Village Parks Staff:** Berkley Green tables and chairs are popular. Colleen to ask John Dixon if more are existing in storage.
4. **Adjourn** at 7:30 p.m.: Motion by Ashley Garwood, Second by Stacey Allott.